

Heritage Impact Assessment (HIA)

What this tool produces · *A formal evaluation report detailing the potential negative and positive consequences of a proposed urban change on the specific attributes of a cultural heritage site, guiding planning approvals.*

G2 · Proof of Fit

Dimensions

Heritage

Spatial

Regulation

Preparing the workshop · *Heritage Impact Assessment (HIA)*

G2 · Proof of Fit

Why this tool matters

Forcing the arrogance of new developments to pause and bow before the legacy of the past, ensuring that modern progress does not erase the footprints of our ancestors.

Evidence we produce

A formal evaluation report detailing the potential negative and positive consequences of a proposed urban change on the specific attributes of a cultural heritage site, guiding planning approvals.

Duration & Material

Duration · 2 to 6 months of assessment depending on project scale

Material · Statement of Outstanding Universal Value (SoOUV), architectural plans, impact assessment matrices

Reference case

ICOMOS developed the HIA methodology specifically to protect World Heritage properties. It requires planners to explicitly cross-reference any new infrastructure or zoning change against the specific attributes of the site's Outstanding Universal Value. This procedural check ensures decision-makers prioritize heritage conservation over raw development needs and mitigate negative impacts.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) › Method walk-through (15 min) › Animation canvas (60-90 min) › Harvest (20 min)

Heritage values × intervention × impact severity

Duration
2 to 6 months of assessment depending on project scale

Heritage values	Proposed intervention	Direct impacts	Mitigation measures
<i>Aesthetic, historic, scientific, social</i>	<i>What the project does to the asset</i>	<i>positive, negligible, adverse</i>	<i>How adverse impacts will be reduced</i>

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.